

100 Days of Linux - Day 053

Title: Downloading Files with wget

Today's Goal

Learn how to download files, resume interrupted downloads, and save files with custom names using the **wget** command.

Why This Matters

Engineers use wget to download datasets, software packages, logs, and backups directly from servers and cloud storage.

Command of the Day: wget

Common Syntax:

```
wget https://example.com/file.zip  
wget -O myfile.zip https://example.com/file.zip  
wget -c https://example.com/file.zip (resume download)  
wget -P downloads/ https://example.com/file.zip
```

Common Options:

- O = Save with a custom filename
- c = Continue an interrupted download
- P = Save to a specific directory
- q = Quiet mode

Beginner Lesson

Unlike curl, wget is primarily designed for downloading files. It can automatically resume interrupted downloads, making it useful for large datasets and software packages.

Practice Questions

1. Use wget to download https://example.com and save the result with the default filename.
2. Download https://example.com again but save it as homepage.html using the appropriate option.
3. Create a folder named downloads and save a downloaded file inside it.
4. Explain how you would resume an interrupted download using wget, then practice the command if possible.
5. Display your current working directory after completing today's tasks.

Hints

Use -O to rename a downloaded file and -P to choose the destination folder.

Mini Challenge

Create a downloads folder. Download two different web pages into it using custom filenames. Compare their sizes with ls -lh.

Common Mistakes

Using `wget` when you only need to inspect an API response. `curl` is usually better for API testing, while `wget` excels at downloading files.

Did You Know?

`wget` can resume large downloads after a network interruption, saving time and bandwidth.

Pro Tip

Use `wget -c` for large downloads so you don't have to restart from the beginning if the connection drops.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `wget https://example.com`

Q2: `wget -O homepage.html https://example.com`

Q3: `mkdir downloads && wget -P downloads https://example.com`

Q4: `wget -c https://example.com/file.zip` (example syntax)

Q5: `pwd`

Homework

Download several files into different folders and practice using `-O`, `-P`, and `-c` until the commands feel natural.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn SSH to securely connect to remote Linux systems from the command line.